

André Thevet, *Les vrais pourtraits et vies des hommes illustres*, Paris, 1584

Strabo

about 64 BC to about AD 24

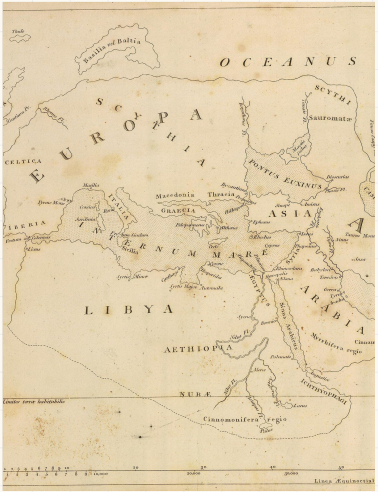


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Strabo

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His Geography*: seventeen books, the whole inhabited world, region by region*



James Playfair, the world according to Strabo, 1814. David Rumsey Collection

Its utility

[…] its utility is manifold, not only as regards the activities of statesmen and commanders but also as regards knowledge both of the heavens and of things on land and sea, animals, plants, fruits, and everything else to be seen in various regions […]

Strabo, *Geography* I.1.1. English: H. L. Jones, 1917.



The Peutinger Table, a Roman road map, in Konrad Miller's edition of 1888

How large, how it lies

[…] the greater part of geography subserves the needs of states […] For thus they can manage their various affairs in a more satisfactory manner, if they know how large a country is, how it lies, and what are its peculiarities either of sky or soil.

Strabo, *Geography* I.1.16. English: H. L. Jones, 1917.



Paolo Uccello, *The Hunt in the Forest*, about 1470. Ashmolean Museum, Oxford

Only one who knows a region

The utility of geography in matters of small concern, also, is quite evident; for instance, in hunting. A hunter will be more successful in the chase if he knows the character and extent of the forest; and again, only one who knows a region can advantageously pitch camp there, or set an ambush, or direct a march.

Strabo, *Geography* I.1.17. English: H. L. Jones, 1917.



Jacques-Louis David, *Leonidas at Thermopylae*, 1814. Musée du Louvre

The prizes of knowledge

The utility of geography is more conspicuous, however, in great undertakings, in proportion as the prizes of knowledge and the disasters that result from ignorance are greater. Thus Agamemnon and his fleet ravaged Mysia in the belief that it was Troy-land, and came back home in disgrace.

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[. . .] There have also been cases of success, in which success was due to acquaintance with the regions involved; for instance, at the pass of Thermopylae it is said that Ephialtes, by showing the Persians the pathway across the mountains, put Leonidas and his troops at their mercy, and brought the Persians south of Thermopylae.

Strabo, *Geography* I.1.17. English: H. L. Jones, 1917.



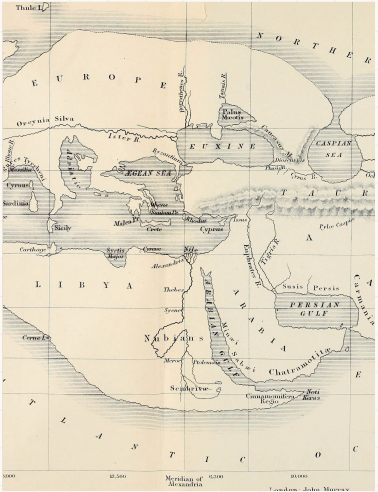
The Carta Pisana, a sea chart, late 13th century. Bibliothèque nationale de France

On a plane surface

Best, he says first, is a globe at least ten feet across.

But if he cannot construct a globe of adequate size or not much smaller, he should sketch his map on a plane surface of at least seven feet. For it will make only a slight difference if we draw straight lines to represent the circles, that is, the parallels and meridians […] for our imagination can easily transfer to the globular and spherical surface the figure or magnitude seen by the eye on a plane surface.

Strabo, *Geography* II.5.10. English: H. L. Jones, 1917.

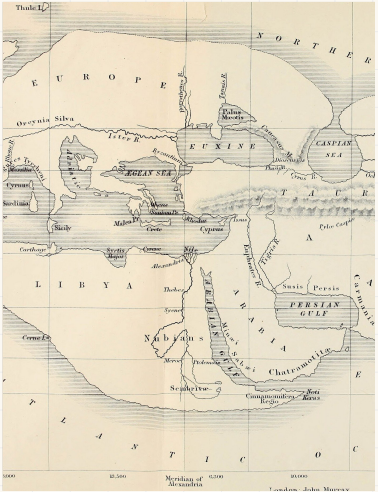


Eratosthenes' world, as drawn by E. H. Bunbury, 1883

Two lines

[…] two of them have already been so drawn, I mean the two central lines mentioned above, the one representing the length and the other the breadth; and the other lines will be easily found by the help of these two. For by using these lines as "elements," so to speak, we can correlate the regions that are parallel, and the other positions, both geographical and astronomical, of inhabited places.

Strabo, *Geography* II.5.16. English: H. L. Jones, 1917.



Eratosthenes' world, as drawn by E. H. Bunbury, 1883

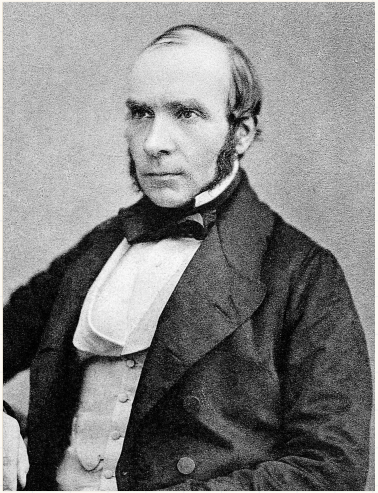
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Jones's footnote on "elements", 1917:

Or, as we would say, "axes of co-ordinates." (Strabo has in mind something similar to our system of co-ordinates in analytical geometry.)

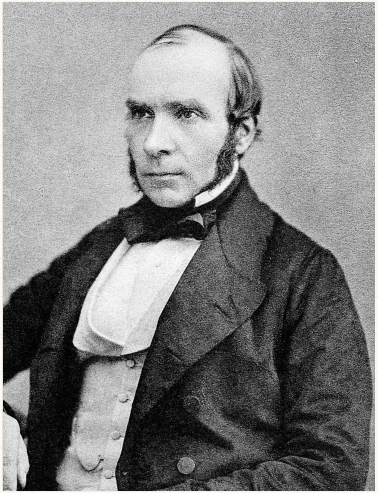
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John Snow, 1856

John Snow

1813 to 1858



John Snow, 1856

John Snow

1813 to 1858

A London physician. In 1854 cholera broke out in Soho, and he put its deaths on a map of the streets.



Detail of John Snow's map of the deaths from cholera around Broad Street, 1854

Broad Street, 1854

The most terrible outbreak of cholera which ever occurred in this kingdom, is probably that which took place in Broad Street, Golden Square, and the adjoining streets, a few weeks ago. Within two hundred and fifty yards of the spot where Cambridge Street joins Broad Street, there were upwards of five hundred fatal attacks of cholera in ten days.

John Snow, *On the Mode of Communication of Cholera*, 1855.



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[…] On proceeding to the spot, I found that nearly all the deaths had taken place within a short distance of the pump.

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[…] In consequence of what I said, the handle of the pump was removed on the following day.

John Snow, *On the Mode of Communication of Cholera*, 1855.

Where the weekend goes

	Friday
Two lines, and every picture has its place.	Manifolds
Read off a photo how it lies.	Predicting from a photo
Know the region before you march.	Manifold games
From the flat chart back to the round world.	Variational autoencoders
The same soil under another sky.	Conditional VAEs and age progression
Direct a march from noise to a picture.	Stable diffusion
For statesmen, commanders, and everyone else.	Future of AI

Where the weekend goes

	Saturday
Mysia, taken for Troy.	Adversarial attacks
A pathway across the mountains.	Attacks on LLMs
Tell Troy from Mysia.	Project intro: Deepfake detection and generation